



RELOCATION GUIDE

Relocating to Portland

Neighborhoods, market insight, and everyday life in the City of Roses — prepared for buyers considering a move to the Pacific Northwest.

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Welcome to Portland

CITY OF ROSES

Tucked between the Willamette and Columbia Rivers and framed by Mount Hood on clear days, Portland has long drawn newcomers with a simple promise: a walkable, design-forward city where nature is never more than a bridge crossing away.

It is a city of neighborhoods rather than one downtown core — each with its own character, main street, and pace of life — which is why choosing where to live matters just as much as choosing whether to move here at all.

This guide is a starting point: a quick orientation to the neighborhoods, the market, and the everyday rhythms of life in Portland, so our first conversation can begin where the guidebooks leave off.

QUICK FACTS

652K+

CITY POPULATION

95

DISTINCT NEIGHBORHOODS

Temperate

WET WINTERS, DRY SUMMERS

PDX

DIRECT INT'L AIRPORT

01

WALKABLE BY DESIGN

Compact blocks and a light-rail and streetcar network make car-free days realistic in most close-in neighborhoods.

02

NO SALES TAX

Oregon has no statewide sales tax, a detail that shapes both everyday spending and relocation budgeting.

03

NATURE AT THE EDGE

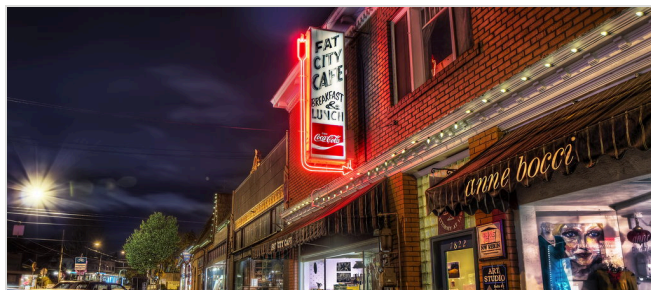
Forest Park, the Gorge, the Coast, and Mount Hood are each under two hours from most front doors.



DOWNTOWN PORTLAND AND MOUNT HOOD · AUTUMN FROM THE WEST SIDE

Southwest & the West Hills

WHERE I FOCUS



Multnomah Village

SOUTHWEST

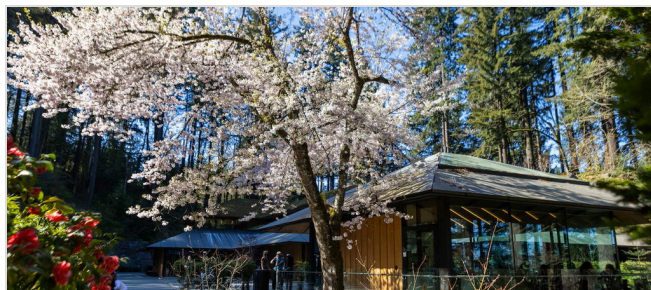
A walkable village center of independent bookshops, cafes, and pubs, wrapped in character homes on quiet streets. Small-town texture inside the city, and one of Southwest Portland's most sought-after addresses.



Council Crest

WEST HILLS

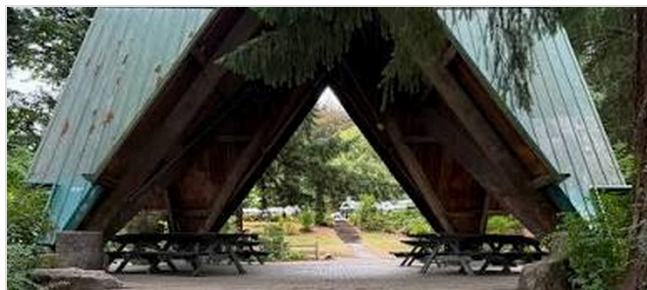
Portland's highest point, with Cascade views from the park at its summit. Winding hillside streets, architect-designed homes, and downtown only minutes down the hill.



Bridlemile

SOUTHWEST

Wooded and quiet, with generous lots, mature trees, and a well-regarded neighborhood elementary school. A favorite for buyers who want space and greenery without leaving the city.



Sylvan Highlands

WEST HILLS

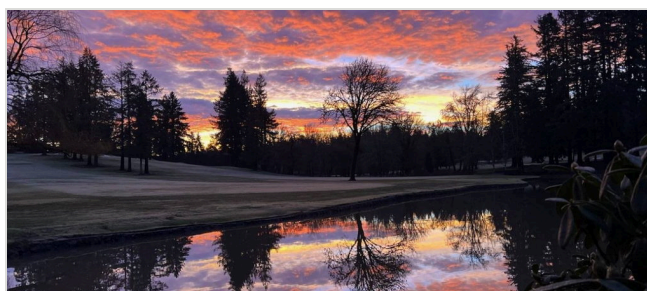
A forested hillside enclave just off Highway 26, offering fast downtown access and a secluded, tucked-away feel that belies how central it actually is.



Forest Heights

WEST HILLS

A master-planned hillside community with newer construction, its own village center, and trails threading the surrounding woods. Appeals to buyers who want turnkey homes and amenities together.



Raleigh Hills

WASHINGTON COUNTY

An established, convenient pocket along the Beaverton-Hillsdale corridor. Mature landscaping, mid-century and updated homes, and easy reach of both Portland and the westside.

Westside & South Metro

JUST BEYOND THE CITY



WASHINGTON COUNTY

West Slope

A leafy unincorporated pocket sitting between Portland and Beaverton, known for mid-century homes on generous lots and mature tree cover. Quiet and established, with quick access in both directions — a practical choice for buyers who want westside convenience without a hillside price.



CLACKAMAS COUNTY

Lake Oswego

An affluent lakeside city roughly eight miles south of downtown, with a polished village center along A Avenue, highly regarded schools, and a Willamette River frontage. Housing runs from lakefront estates to wooded contemporary homes on quiet cul-de-sacs.



CLACKAMAS COUNTY

West Linn

Set on the bluffs above the Willamette near the falls, West Linn pairs strong schools with wooded residential streets, generous parks, and a genuine small-city feel. Popular with buyers trading a slightly longer commute for square footage and quiet.

Close-In Portland

EAST SIDE & NORTHWEST

Portland's east side and inner Northwest keep a different rhythm — denser, highly walkable, and rich in early-20th-century housing stock. If your search leads across the river, these are the districts worth knowing.

The Pearl District

NORTHWEST

Portland's most polished urban address: converted warehouses, galleries, and farm-to-table dining. Condo living in the middle of it all, on a compact and level street grid.

Nob Hill / NW District

NORTHWEST

Restored Queen Anne and Victorian homes on leafy streets, steps from NW 23rd's boutiques and cafes. Charm with genuine walkability.

Irvington

NORTHEAST

One of the largest concentrations of early-20th-century architecture in the Pacific Northwest. A prestige historic address close to downtown.

Alberta Arts District

NORTHEAST

Galleries, murals, and globally-inspired restaurants along a creative, independent-minded strip. Bungalow character homes and a neighborhood-first culture.

Sellwood-Moreland

SOUTHEAST

A quieter riverside pocket of Victorian homes and antique shops, with easy access to the Springwater Corridor trail. A mix of cottages, bungalows, and condominiums on walkable blocks.

Hawthorne District

SOUTHEAST

Portland's bohemian core — vintage shops, indie bookstores, and an easygoing, eclectic pace. Personality over polish.



DOWNTOWN AFTER RAIN - THE TRANSIT MALL AT PIONEER PLACE

The Market, In Brief

PORTLAND METRO

\$535,509

MEDIAN HOME SALE PRICE

14 Days

MEDIAN TIME ON MARKET

43%

HOMES SELLING ABOVE LIST

MARKET CHARACTER

- Portland's market remains competitive: the typical home receives roughly two offers and moves off market in about two weeks.
- Homes are selling at roughly 101% of list price on average, with well-priced, move-in-ready listings drawing the most competition.
- Price per square foot has held near \$315, a helpful benchmark when comparing neighborhoods.

COST OF LIVING NOTES

- Oregon levies no state sales tax, which offsets a moderate state income tax for many households.
- Property tax is calculated under Oregon's assessed-value system, which can keep bills more predictable than in market-value states.
- Utilities and groceries trend close to national averages; housing is the primary cost variable, and it varies widely by neighborhood.

Market figures reflect recent Redfin data for the Portland, OR metro area and are illustrative as of this guide's printing. Ask Catherine for a current, neighborhood-level analysis prepared for your search.



A SUMMER FARMERS MARKET DOWNTOWN

Life in the City of Roses

DAY TO DAY

CLIMATE

Four Real Seasons

Mild, wet winters and warm, dry summers define the year. Rain is frequent but rarely heavy, and summer months are consistently sunny — ideal for the outdoor culture Portland is known for.

OUTDOORS

Nature Close at Hand

Forest Park's 80+ miles of trails sit inside city limits, while the Columbia River Gorge, Mount Hood, and the Oregon Coast are all within roughly 90 minutes' drive.

SCHOOLS

Education Options

Public districts vary meaningfully by neighborhood, and the metro area includes a strong roster of private schools. We map your home search to school priorities from day one.

GETTING AROUND

Transit & Bikeability

MAX light rail, the streetcar, and an extensive bike network connect most close-in neighborhoods. Many residents in the Pearl, Northwest, and inner Southeast go car-light or car-free entirely.

FOOD & CULTURE

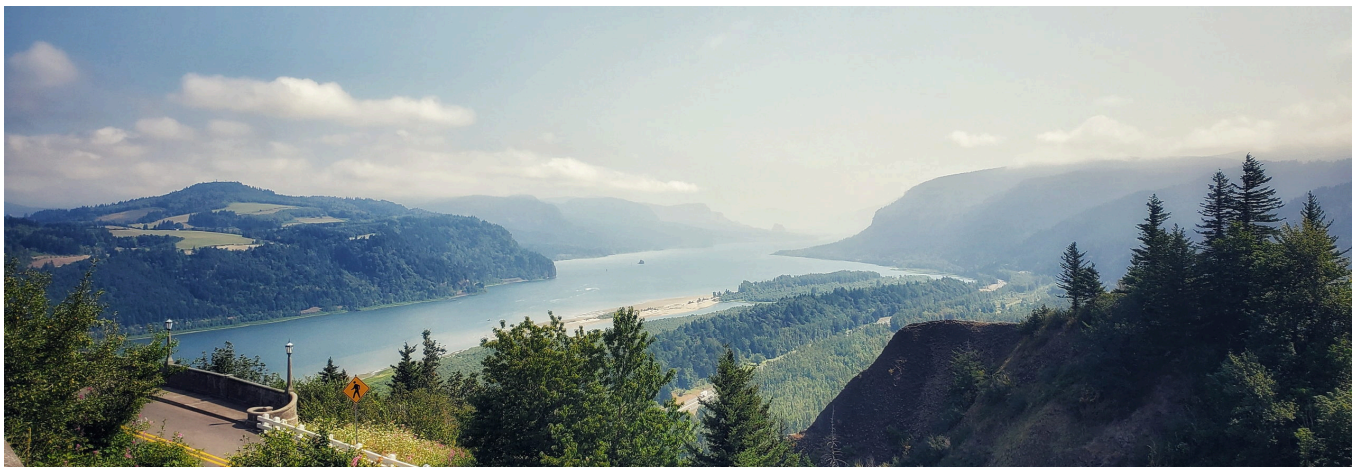
A Genuine Food City

From food carts to James Beard-recognized kitchens, Portland's dining scene rivals cities many times its size — alongside a deep-rooted coffee, craft beer, and wine culture.

AIRPORT

Easy In, Easy Out

Portland International Airport (PDX) offers direct flights across the U.S. and internationally, and sits a quick MAX ride from downtown.



THE COLUMBIA RIVER GORGE FROM THE HISTORIC HIGHWAY · THIRTY MINUTES EAST

Let's find your place in Portland.

Every neighborhood in this guide tells a different story — the right one for you depends on commute, budget, school priorities, and the kind of daily life you want to build. That conversation is where we start.

— Personalized neighborhood shortlist

— School & commute mapping

— Current market & pricing guidance

— Remote & relocation buyer support



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